Strong 2-♣ Opening

Open 2♣ on any hand containing 22 or more points.
OR, open 2♣ with a hand containing 19-21 points and with 9+ playing tricks.

There are several methods of responding. For these Deals use the 2♦ Negative for all hands with 7 or fewer points. Any other response shows 8 or more points.

The 2♣ bid is artificial; Opener's second bid describes her hand.
2NT shows a balanced 22-24 point hand
3NT shows a balanced 25-27 point hand
2 of a suit shows a 5-card or longer suit

With a very weak hand (0-3 points) Responder should bid the "second negative" at his second turn. This is usually 3♣, but if Opener bids 3♣ then it is 3♦. If Opener should bid 3♦ at his second turn the second negative bid is 3♥.

Later bidding depends on the partnership, but unless particular conventions are in use then later bidding is natural.

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣A

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠7

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: South
Lead: ♠4

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♥4

Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ A J 10 7 2 ♥ 9 8 7 ♦ 8 2 ♣ Q 5 3	
♠ 9 5 ♥ 10 5 3 ♦ 10 7 6 5 3 ♣ K 10 2		♠ 4 3 ♥ Q 6 4 ♦ J 9 4 ♣ A J 9 7 4
	♠ K Q 8 6 ♥ A K J 2 ♦ A K Q ♣ 8 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♣A

SOUTH has a minimum 2♣ opening.

NORTH, with 8 points and a 5-card suit, should make a positive response, 2♠.

SOUTH shows the ♠ support first, to set the trump suit, and to give NORTH an opportunity for a move toward slam if he wants to do so.

NORTH would now make a Control-showing bid IF HE HAD A CONTROL. Since he doesn't he just returns to 4♠ which SOUTH passes.

Board 2
West Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 4 2 ♥ 10 9 4 3 ♦ Q J 2 ♣ K Q 10 2	
♠ A Q 9 ♥ A K 2 ♦ A 8 3 ♣ A J 7 4	N W E S	♠ K 6 3 ♥ Q 8 5 ♦ K 7 6 4 ♣ 9 5 3
	♠ J 10 8 7 5 ♥ J 7 6 ♦ 10 9 5 ♣ 8 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2♣	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			

3NT by East
Lead: ♠7

WEST, with 22 points and balanced, opens 2♣, expecting to rebid 2NT.

But EAST responds a positive 2NT, showing a balanced hand with 8 or more points.

WEST bids what his hand is worth, 3NT and EAST passes.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ Q J 7 2 ♥ Q 10 7 5 ♦ 7 2 ♣ 8 5 4	
♠ 6 5 4 ♥ 9 6 4 3 ♦ Q J 9 ♣ J 7 6		♠ 10 8 3 ♥ K ♦ K 10 8 5 4 3 ♣ Q 10 2
	♠ A K 9 ♥ A J 8 2 ♦ A 6 ♣ A K 9 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♣	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by South
Lead: ♠4

SOUTH opens 2♣ and NORTH responds 2♦ showing fewer than 8 points.

SOUTH bids 2NT with a 23 point balanced hand.

NORTH has enough points to bid 3NT, but with two 4-card Major suits bids 3♣ Stayman instead. SOUTH won't confuse this as the second negative since that bid isn't used after a 2NT rebid.

So SOUTH shows her 4-card ♥ suit and NORTH bids 4♥.

Board 4
East Deals
Both Vul

	♠ J 10 8 7 ♥ 4 3 ♦ Q J 10 9 5 ♣ 9 6	
♠ Q 6 3 ♥ Q 8 5 ♦ K 7 6 4 ♣ K J 3	N W E S	♠ A K 9 ♥ A K 2 ♦ A 8 3 ♣ A Q 7 4
	♠ 5 4 2 ♥ J 10 9 7 6 ♦ 2 ♣ 10 8 5 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♣	Pass
2NT	Pass	3NT	Pass
6NT			
All Pass			

6NT by West
Lead: ♥4

WEST has a balanced hand with 11 points, so she responds 2NT to EAST's 2♣ opening bid.

EAST bids 3NT. This shows 22-24 points, a hand he was planning to rebid 2NT.

WEST knows the side has at least 33 points, but no more than 35 so she bids 6NT.